

Prairie Horizon® Manchurian Alder

Alnus hirsuta 'Harbin' (Family: *Betulaceae*)

Description: Non-U.S. native tree. The most drought-tolerant alder that was evaluated in NDSU trials. Rapid-growing, medium-sized tree with lush dark green leaves is an attractive tree for dry difficult sites. The bark is gray and beech-like. Purple catkins and clusters of brown, cone-like strobiles add interest to the tree throughout winter.

Hardiness: USDA hardiness zones 3 to 7

Native Habitat: Central and Northern Asia.

Mature Size: Height: 30', Spread: 25'

Form (Shape): Upright oval.

Growth Rate: Moderate to Fast.

Foliage: Deciduous. Leaves are a dark glossy green in the summer and turn yellow in the fall.

Texture: Medium.

Flowers: Produces reddish-brown flowers (catkins) in March, not ornamental.

Fruit: small, cone-shaped strobiles (seeds are small nutlet) are produced from October to November.

Light: Full sun to part shade.

Soil: Performs well in compacted, dry soils. It is pH tolerant, including alkaline soils.

Propagation: Softwood cuttings and grafting.

Tree Failure Patterns: Sapsuckers can girdle and kill the tree.

Disease and Insects: Susceptible to woolly alder aphid (AKA maple blight aphid) and sapsuckers.

Landscape Use: Shape and texture of summer foliage is unique and interesting. Strobiles add an interesting winter feature to the tree. Recommended as a landscape specimen tree. An excellent tree for difficult, dry locations. Performs well on boulevards and in parking lot islands. Drought tolerant. It has not shown any invasive tendencies.

Availability: Available in trade.